Lena Varga-Holm

Senior Data Engineer

Professional Summary

Senior Data Engineer with experience designing, building and operating production data platforms across logistics and payments. Owns ingestion and orchestration using Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka, with Python, SQL and AWS experience. Delivered streaming pipelines processing around 30 million events per day, faster warehouse builds and substantial cost reductions. Combines platform ownership and on-call operations with mentoring, data quality engineering and open-source contributions.

Technical Skills

- Languages: Python, SQL, PySpark
- Orchestration and transformation: Airflow, dbt, incremental models
- Cloud and warehouses: AWS, EMR, S3, Glue Data Catalog, MSK, Snowflake, Redshift
- Streaming and ingestion: Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, PostgreSQL, Snowpipe Streaming
- Engineering practices: Terraform, Git, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, pytest
- Data quality and modelling: Great Expectations, dbt tests and documentation, warehouse design, incremental materialized views

Professional Experience

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. | 2022–Present

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform using Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka; participate in a one-week-in-six on-call rotation.
- Designed and built a shipment event streaming pipeline processing around 30 million events per day with end-to-end p95 latency under two minutes, using partner webhooks, Kafka, Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming on AWS MSK.
- Added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling to reprocess failed events without data loss.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into dbt models with tests and documentation; introduced incremental models and slim CI using state:modified in GitHub Actions.
- Cut nightly warehouse build time from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes and made lineage visible to analysts.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25% in 2024.
- Reduced monthly Snowflake costs by approximately 37% in 2024 through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.
- Mentor two mid-level engineers and run data platform office hours.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay | 2019–2022

- Developed PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files against internal ledgers, using S3, Glue Data Catalog, Redshift and Great Expectations.
- Reduced finance's manual month-end reconciliation work from approximately three days to four hours.
- Worked on Redshift warehouse design and data quality with Great Expectations.

BI Developer / ETL Responsibilities | Adria Retail Group | Earlier experience

- Started as a BI developer and gradually took over most ETL work during two years at the company.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS packages to Python scripts, making loads easier to debug and change and reducing dependence on a single SSIS specialist.

Education

MSc in Computer Science | Northgate Technical University
Thesis: Incremental materialized views

Certification

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | Earned May 2024

Open Source and Community

- Contributed two merged pull requests to an Airflow provider package in 2023, fixing an API pagination bug and adding tests using Python and pytest.
- Presented "Data contracts without the hype" at a regional data meetup in 2024.
- Teach beginner SQL at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.